

13 ways you're getting scr**ed

And you thought you were treated like a King?

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Everybody knows that economies need us consumers to spend; and in order to do so, we need to have products we desire. All companies have R&D departments that innovate in order to bring you the latest upgrades in technology, however, sometimes technology growth plateaus. It's in such lean growth periods where boardrooms full of men with sweaty palms, start worrying about shareholders, and how to afford their kid's next Ferrari. Mess with a trust fund, and a brainwave or six are born!

Although innovation is widely considered the best way to make a profit, there's still hard cash being made by creating hype, misleading the public and re-inventing the wheel. Then again, why wait for a slump in progress to do this? terms such as "all new", "v2.0", "one-of-a-kind", etc., are garnished with a billion dollar ad campaign and served cold to us ravenous consumers. Don't believe us? Consider the following ways in which you're being made as ass of here in India:

1. Geeks be damned

As a Digit reader, you're plumb out of luck. Because the very fact that you're not the average consumer plays against you. Although manufacturers are thrilled when their devices are capable of being

modded in some way – by rooting and installing custom firmware, or over-clocking – they usually ensure that such actions void warranty. If something does go wrong, and it's your actions that have caused the hardware failure, then they're perfectly justified – for example, if you mod your device to run at a higher CPU clock speed than you should, which fries something important. However, very often, they escape providing warranty for hardware failures that would have occurred whether you had modded or not – such as memory corruption, or antenna failure, or for PCs, motherboard component failures, etc.

<http://dgit.in/Rm1ZuE>

2. After sales? lol :-)

If you've bought something recently from a major retailer, you'll have noticed that they promise to give you a hassle free shopping experience, and for the most bit, they do. It's only when something goes wrong with your product that you get a first-hand lesson in playing the blame game. Although you expect them to take care of warranty claims, they only write down the address of an RMA centre and hand it to you. You're lucky if this is even in your city (if you don't live in a metro). We've heard that major retailers only offer proper service for items imported by them, or for their own brand.

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3. Premium

Thanks to digitization (SATA-III, HDMI 1.3, et al), the types of cables you have to know about these days has skyrocketed. You're told about the superior speeds / signal bandwidth so-and-so cable offers, and it's mostly hogwash.

New revisions in a protocol have little to do with a cable. Technically, there is no difference between, say, SATA-II and SATA-III cables. The protocol revision only affects the hardware and software on the system, the cable part was left the same for the sake of compatibility, but that doesn't stop people from branding a cable specifically for a particular port, changing a colour, and charging a premium for it. HDMI is a different story – the cables are actually different, but there are people offering connectors and weird cables – promising bandwidth that even HDMI hardware doesn't offer just yet.

If you're confused, just choose an HDMI cable with "High Speed with Ethernet" or basically the HDMI 1.4 standard. That's not all though. There are manufacturers who also use the "Premium" tag to market exactly the same product with just an upgraded firmware – factory overclocked GPUs with standard cooling, and entry-level DSLRs that can be flashed to give you features of more expensive models are some examples.

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